

# **WHEN SOMEONE YOU LOVE IS ADDICTED**

A Workbook for Families

Boundaries, Self-Care, and Healing  
for Those Who Love an Addict

**By Daniel Tesfamariam**

## **WHEN SOMEONE YOU LOVE IS ADDICTED**

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If you are in crisis, call 988 or Al-Anon: 1-888-425-2666

# ADDICTION IS A FAMILY DISEASE

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When one person is addicted, EVERYONE in the family is affected.

You did not cause this. You cannot control it. You cannot cure it.

But you CAN heal from its effects on YOUR life.

## HOW ADDICTION AFFECTS FAMILIES:

- Constant worry, fear, and hypervigilance
- Walking on eggshells to avoid conflict
- Financial strain from enabling or consequences
- Broken trust and repeated disappointments
- Isolation (shame keeps you from telling others)
- Loss of identity (your life revolves around them)
- Physical symptoms: insomnia, headaches, stomach issues
- Children in the home absorb the chaos

## COMMON FAMILY ROLES:

- The Enabler: protects the addict from consequences
- The Hero: tries to make everything look perfect
- The Scapegoat: acts out to divert attention
- The Lost Child: withdraws and becomes invisible
- The Mascot: uses humor to diffuse tension

Which role(s) do I play? \_\_\_\_\_

## THIS WORKBOOK WILL HELP YOU:

1. Understand what you CAN and CANNOT control
2. Set boundaries that protect your well-being
3. Practice detachment with love
4. Build your own support system
5. Begin your own healing journey

# THE 3 Cs

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The foundation of Al-Anon and family recovery:

I did not CAUSE it.

- Addiction is a brain disease, not a moral failing
- Nothing you did or did not do made them addicted
- You are not responsible for their choices
- Let go of guilt for 'what I should have done differently'

What I need to stop blaming myself for:

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I cannot CONTROL it.

- You cannot love someone into sobriety
- Begging, threatening, and bargaining do not work long-term
- Their recovery is THEIR responsibility
- You are powerless over another person's choices

What I have been trying to control that is not mine to control:

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I cannot CURE it.

- There is no magic thing you can say or do
- Recovery is a personal journey they must choose
- You can support without taking responsibility
- Your job is to heal YOURSELF

What I need to accept I am powerless over:

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# CODEPENDENCY SELF-ASSESSMENT

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Check all that apply to you. Be honest - this is for YOUR awareness.

- ☐ I feel responsible for other people's feelings and actions
- ☐ I have difficulty saying 'no' even when I want to
- ☐ I put others' needs before my own consistently
- ☐ I try to fix, manage, or control other people's problems
- ☐ I feel guilty when I do something for myself
- ☐ I stay in relationships that are harmful to me
- ☐ I need external approval to feel good about myself
- ☐ I am afraid of being abandoned or alone
- ☐ I confuse love with pity or rescuing
- ☐ I tolerate behavior from others that I would not accept from myself
- ☐ I have difficulty identifying my own feelings
- ☐ I am more aware of others' feelings than my own
- ☐ I feel anxious when I am not needed
- ☐ I make excuses for my loved one's addiction
- ☐ I lie to cover up the addict's behavior
- ☐ I check their phone, belongings, or whereabouts obsessively
- ☐ I have lost friendships because of this situation
- ☐ I have neglected my own health, hobbies, or goals
- ☐ I feel crazy, exhausted, or hopeless most days
- ☐ I believe if I just love them enough, they will change

**Total checked: \_\_\_\_/20**

0-5: Minimal codependency 6-10: Moderate 11-15: Significant 16+: Severe

Remember: This is not a diagnosis. It is awareness. Healing starts here.

# ENABLING vs HELPING

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ENABLING removes consequences. HELPING supports recovery.

ENABLING looks like:

- Paying their bills/rent
- Lying to cover for them
- Giving money (used for drugs)
- Bailing them out of jail
- Making excuses to employer
- Cleaning up their messes
- Ignoring the problem

HELPING looks like:

- Letting them face consequences
- Being honest with others
- Offering to pay for treatment
- Providing information on resources
- Expressing concern with boundaries
- Attending your own recovery meetings
- Naming the problem honestly

MY ENABLING BEHAVIORS (be specific and honest):

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_

WHY I ENABLE (what am I afraid will happen if I stop?):

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ONE ENABLING BEHAVIOR I COMMIT TO STOPPING THIS WEEK:

\_\_\_\_\_

What might happen: \_\_\_\_\_

How I will cope: \_\_\_\_\_

# BOUNDARY SETTING - EXERCISE 1

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## Focus area: MONEY/FINANCES

THE SITUATION (what keeps happening):

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HOW IT AFFECTS ME (emotionally, physically, financially):

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MY BOUNDARY (what I will no longer accept):

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HOW I WILL COMMUNICATE IT (use calm, clear language):

'I love you AND I need to tell you that \_\_\_\_\_

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Going forward, I will \_\_\_\_\_

If [boundary is crossed], I will \_\_\_\_\_ ,

WHAT IF THEY PUSH BACK? (they will - prepare for it):

They might say: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

They might do: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

MY SUPPORT FOR HOLDING THIS BOUNDARY:

Who I will call if I waver: \_\_\_\_\_

What I will remind myself: \_\_\_\_\_

DATE SET: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_ DID I HOLD IT? [ ] Yes [ ] No

What happened: \_\_\_\_\_

What I learned: \_\_\_\_\_

## BOUNDARY SETTING - EXERCISE 2

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### Focus area: THEIR BEHAVIOR WHEN USING/DRINKING

THE SITUATION (what keeps happening):

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HOW IT AFFECTS ME (emotionally, physically, financially):

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MY BOUNDARY (what I will no longer accept):

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HOW I WILL COMMUNICATE IT (use calm, clear language):

'I love you AND I need to tell you that \_\_\_\_\_

---

Going forward, I will \_\_\_\_\_

If [boundary is crossed], I will \_\_\_\_\_ ,

WHAT IF THEY PUSH BACK? (they will - prepare for it):

They might say: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

They might do: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

MY SUPPORT FOR HOLDING THIS BOUNDARY:

Who I will call if I waver: \_\_\_\_\_

What I will remind myself: \_\_\_\_\_

DATE SET: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_ DID I HOLD IT? [ ] Yes [ ] No

What happened: \_\_\_\_\_

What I learned: \_\_\_\_\_



# BOUNDARY SETTING - EXERCISE 3

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## Focus area: THEIR PRESENCE AROUND CHILDREN

THE SITUATION (what keeps happening):

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HOW IT AFFECTS ME (emotionally, physically, financially):

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MY BOUNDARY (what I will no longer accept):

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HOW I WILL COMMUNICATE IT (use calm, clear language):

'I love you AND I need to tell you that \_\_\_\_\_

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Going forward, I will \_\_\_\_\_

If [boundary is crossed], I will \_\_\_\_\_ ,

WHAT IF THEY PUSH BACK? (they will - prepare for it):

They might say: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

They might do: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

MY SUPPORT FOR HOLDING THIS BOUNDARY:

Who I will call if I waver: \_\_\_\_\_

What I will remind myself: \_\_\_\_\_

DATE SET: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_ DID I HOLD IT? [ ] Yes [ ] No

What happened: \_\_\_\_\_

What I learned: \_\_\_\_\_

# BOUNDARY SETTING - EXERCISE 4

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## Focus area: COMMUNICATION (LIES, MANIPULATION, YELLING)

THE SITUATION (what keeps happening):

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HOW IT AFFECTS ME (emotionally, physically, financially):

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MY BOUNDARY (what I will no longer accept):

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HOW I WILL COMMUNICATE IT (use calm, clear language):

'I love you AND I need to tell you that \_\_\_\_\_

---

Going forward, I will \_\_\_\_\_

If [boundary is crossed], I will \_\_\_\_\_ ,

WHAT IF THEY PUSH BACK? (they will - prepare for it):

They might say: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

They might do: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

MY SUPPORT FOR HOLDING THIS BOUNDARY:

Who I will call if I waver: \_\_\_\_\_

What I will remind myself: \_\_\_\_\_

DATE SET: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_ DID I HOLD IT? [ ] Yes [ ] No

What happened: \_\_\_\_\_

What I learned: \_\_\_\_\_

# BOUNDARY SETTING - EXERCISE 5

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## Focus area: MY HOME AND PERSONAL SPACE

THE SITUATION (what keeps happening):

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HOW IT AFFECTS ME (emotionally, physically, financially):

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---

MY BOUNDARY (what I will no longer accept):

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HOW I WILL COMMUNICATE IT (use calm, clear language):

'I love you AND I need to tell you that \_\_\_\_\_

---

Going forward, I will \_\_\_\_\_

If [boundary is crossed], I will \_\_\_\_\_ ,

WHAT IF THEY PUSH BACK? (they will - prepare for it):

They might say: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

They might do: \_\_\_\_\_

My response: \_\_\_\_\_

MY SUPPORT FOR HOLDING THIS BOUNDARY:

Who I will call if I waver: \_\_\_\_\_

What I will remind myself: \_\_\_\_\_

DATE SET: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_ DID I HOLD IT? [ ] Yes [ ] No

What happened: \_\_\_\_\_

What I learned: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

**Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'**

**DAY 2    Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_**

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

**Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'**

**DAY 3    Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_**

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

**Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'**

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 5**    **Date:** \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 6**    **Date:** \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 8** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 9** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 11** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 12** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

DAY 14 Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

DAY 15 Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'



Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 17** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 18** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 20** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 21** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 23** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 24** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

DAY 26 Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

DAY 27 Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 29** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

**DAY 30** Date: \_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_/\_\_\_\_

Situation that triggered me: \_\_\_\_\_

My reaction (what I did/felt): \_\_\_\_\_

Healthier response (what I could do instead): \_\_\_\_\_

Self-care I did today: \_\_\_\_\_

Mantra: 'I release what I cannot control.'

# AL-ANON / SUPPORT MEETING LOG

Meeting 1 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 2 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 3 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 4 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 5 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 6 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 7 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 8 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 9 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 10 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 11 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

Meeting 12 Date: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ Group: \_\_\_\_\_

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_ My takeaway: \_\_\_\_\_

# MY SUPPORT NETWORK MAP

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You cannot do this alone. Build your support team:

INNER CIRCLE (people I can call anytime, who truly get it):

1. Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

2. Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

3. Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

PROFESSIONAL SUPPORT:

Therapist/Counselor: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

Al-Anon sponsor: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

Family group: \_\_\_\_\_ Meeting day: \_\_\_\_\_

TRUSTED FRIENDS (who I can be honest with):

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

FAITH COMMUNITY (if applicable):

Pastor/leader: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

CRISIS RESOURCES:

Al-Anon: 1-888-425-2666 (Meeting finder: [al-anon.org](http://al-anon.org))

Nar-Anon: [nar-anon.org](http://nar-anon.org)

SAMHSA Helpline: 1-800-662-4357 (free, 24/7)

Crisis line: 988

WHAT I NEED FROM MY SUPPORT PEOPLE:

- Someone to listen without fixing
- Someone to tell me the truth lovingly
- Someone to remind me of my boundaries
- Someone to do fun things with (life beyond addiction)

# MY SELF-CARE PLAN

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You cannot pour from an empty cup. You MATTER.

Self-care is not selfish - it is survival.

DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLES (do these every single day):

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_

WEEKLY SELF-CARE (schedule these like appointments):

- ☐ Exercise/movement: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Social connection: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Something just for me: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Support group/therapy: \_\_\_\_\_

THINGS THAT RECHARGE ME:

1. \_\_\_\_\_ 2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_ 4. \_\_\_\_\_

THINGS I HAVE NEGLECTED (that I am reclaiming):

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_

MY SELF-CARE MANTRA:

, \_\_\_\_\_ ,

WHEN I FEEL GUILTY ABOUT SELF-CARE, I WILL REMEMBER:

- I deserve rest and joy regardless of what they are doing
- Taking care of myself models health for everyone
- I am a better support when I am not depleted



# FAMILY COMMUNICATION SCRIPTS

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## WHEN THEY ARE USING/DRINKING:

'I love you, and I am not going to be around you when you are using. I will be here when you are sober.'

## WHEN THEY ASK FOR MONEY:

'I cannot give you money. I can help you find a treatment program if you are ready. That is what I am willing to offer.'

## WHEN THEY MAKE PROMISES:

'I hear you saying you will change. I hope that is true. I have learned to pay attention to actions, not words. Show me.'

## WHEN FAMILY MEMBERS JUDGE YOU FOR SETTING BOUNDARIES:

'I understand you see this differently. I have to do what keeps me healthy. I hope you can respect that.'

## WHEN TALKING TO CHILDREN ABOUT IT:

'Mommy/Daddy has a sickness that makes them act differently. It is NOT your fault. You are loved and safe.'

## WHEN THEY HIT ROCK BOTTOM:

'I love you. I have found some treatment options. Here they are. I cannot make you go, but I want you to know help is available whenever you are ready.'

## WHEN YOU ARE READY TO STATE YOUR BOUNDARY:

'I love you. Because I love you AND myself, I need to tell you: [state boundary]. This is not a punishment. It is how I stay well.'

Remember: Short. Calm. Consistent. You do not owe explanations.

# WHEN TO SEEK INTERVENTION

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An intervention is a structured conversation where loved ones express concern and present treatment options. Consider it when:

- ☐ Their addiction is life-threatening
- ☐ They refuse to acknowledge the problem
- ☐ Children are at risk
- ☐ Previous conversations have not worked
- ☐ You have support from a professional interventionist

## INTERVENTION PLANNING:

Professional interventionist: \_\_\_\_\_

Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

Treatment facility researched: \_\_\_\_\_

Insurance verified? ☐ Yes ☐ No Coverage: \_\_\_\_\_

## WHO WILL PARTICIPATE:

1. \_\_\_\_\_ Relationship: \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_ Relationship: \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_ Relationship: \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_ Relationship: \_\_\_\_\_

## WHAT IF THEY SAY NO:

My consequence if they refuse treatment:

\_\_\_\_\_

Am I prepared to follow through? ☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

## IMPORTANT: Never attempt an intervention:

- When the person is actively under the influence
- Without professional guidance
- If there is a risk of violence
- If you are not prepared to follow through on consequences

# CRISIS PLAN

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IF THERE IS IMMEDIATE DANGER: Call 911

SIGNS OF OVERDOSE (call 911 immediately):

- Blue lips or fingertips
- Slow or stopped breathing
- Cannot be woken up
- Gurgling or choking sounds
- Seizures

IF I NEED TO LEAVE QUICKLY:

Go-bag location: \_\_\_\_\_

Contents: ☐ ID ☐ Cash ☐ Phone charger ☐ Medications  
☐ Important documents ☐ Clothes for \_\_\_\_ days

Safe place to go: \_\_\_\_\_

Person who will take me in: \_\_\_\_\_

EMERGENCY NUMBERS:

911 (always first if danger)

Local crisis line: \_\_\_\_\_

Domestic violence hotline: 1-800-799-7233

SAMHSA: 1-800-662-4357

My therapist emergency line: \_\_\_\_\_

My sponsor: \_\_\_\_\_

IF CHILDREN ARE INVOLVED:

Who will take them: \_\_\_\_\_

School contact: \_\_\_\_\_

What to tell them: 'We are going to stay with \_\_\_\_ tonight.

You are safe. I love you. This is not your fault.'

I WILL NOT: Stay in an unsafe situation out of guilt or love.

## LETTER TO MY LOVED ONE (UNSENT)

Write everything you need to say. You do not have to send this.

This is for YOUR healing.

Dear \_\_\_\_\_,

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

**With love and boundaries,**

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# PROGRESS REFLECTION

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Look back at where you started. Acknowledge your growth.

WHEN I STARTED THIS WORKBOOK, I FELT:

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NOW I FEEL:

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BOUNDARIES I HAVE SET AND MAINTAINED:

1. 

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2. 

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3. 

---

ENABLING BEHAVIORS I HAVE STOPPED:

1. 

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2. 

---

SELF-CARE PRACTICES I HAVE STARTED:

1. 

---
2. 

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WHAT I AM MOST PROUD OF:

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WHAT STILL NEEDS WORK:

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MY NEXT STEP IN MY OWN RECOVERY:

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REMINDER: Their recovery is their journey.

YOUR recovery is YOUR journey. Keep going.